

GNOME

Gnome, with its *Keep it Simple & Stupid* (KISS) policy is the desktop environment of choice for millions and also the default option for Ubuntu, which is arguably the most popular desktop distribution. Here are a few pointers towards tweaking Gnome a little more to satisfy the power-user in you.

Uniform theme for root applications

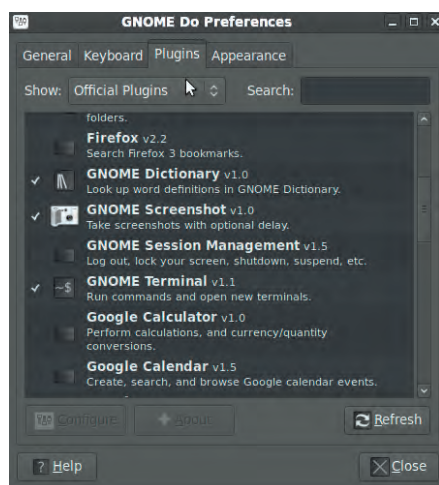
If you've changed your theme that was installed as a different user, and then launch a GUI application with root privileges, you'll notice that it still starts with the old theme. To do this, open the terminal and type in the following commands sequentially:

```
$ sudo ln -s ~/.themes
/root/.themes
$ sudo ln -s ~/.icons
/root/.icons
$ sudo ln -s ~/.fonts
/root/.fonts
```

This creates symlinks for the icons, fonts and theme directory between the current user and the root.

Gnome-DO

Gnome-Do is an application launcher and much more, inspired by QuickSilver for Mac. Think of it as a super-charged replacement for your [Alt]+[F2] default



If you can think of it, there is a plug-in for it



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Gnome-Launcher. In some distributions, it is available by default in the repositories. For the rest, there are detailed instructions on the official web site at http://do.davebsd.com/wiki/Installing_Do. For Ubuntu 9.04 the PPA repositories are as following:

```
deb http://ppa.launchpad.net/do-core/ppa/ubuntu jaunty main
deb-src http://ppa.launchpad.net/do-core/ppa/ubuntu jaunty main
```

After this, a simple `sudo apt-get update` followed by `sudo apt-get install gnome-do` should do the trick.

You can summon `gnome-do` by pressing [Win+D] + Space bar and then type the first few letters to launch an application, open a folder, update your twitter, do a dictionary lookup, control your music and anything just short of learning the art of Zen.

Nautilus scripts

Nautilus is a Gnome file manager and it supports scriptable right-click actions. So you can resize images, converts audio

certain functionality, especially multimedia related task. Therefore, it is advisable to install the following packages if you don't already have them.

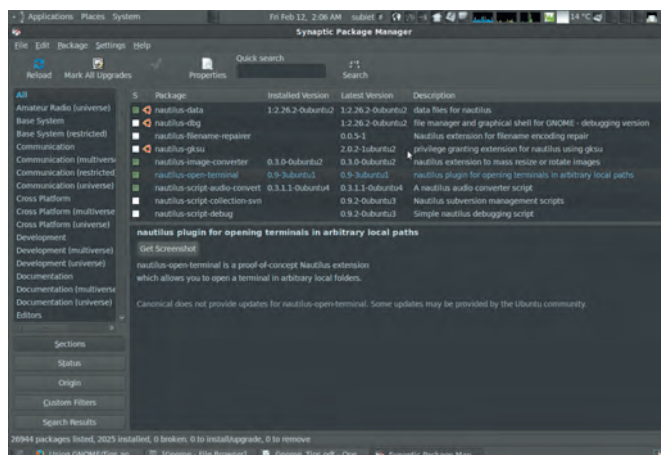
Imagemagick

This is Photoshop in command line, all image related functionality depends on it.

Mencoder and transcode: For audio/video conversion tasks. On a Debian-based distribution, either you can use synaptics to install them or type the following in the command line: `$ sudo apt-get install mencoder transcode imagemagick`

If you find Nautilus Scripts over whelming, you can get some of the functionality by installing the following packages:

```
nautilus-open-terminal
nautilus-image-converter
nautilus-script-audio-convert
```



A small package that lets you open a terminal in the current folder

format, encode video for your mobile and more without launching any other application. First go to <http://g-scripts.sourceforge.net/nautilus-scripts.tar.gz> and download all the scripts. After extracting the package, simply put the contents in your `.gnome` directory located in your home directory.

These are only scripts and depend on other software for

One click to root

If you frequently find yourself moving or editing files that require root permission and find it cumbersome to either use the command line or open a specific folder in Nautilus with root privileges each time, you can make a simple shortcut to save time.

Right-click on any panel or the desktop to create a launcher.